

THE Gen Z SHOW

How do Gen Z members consume content? The BT-PRICE Gen Z Consumption Behaviour Survey finds it prefers shorter formats that require less attention spans

BY ARCHNA SHUKLA

GONE ARE THE days of “appointment viewing” on a static screen in the living room. Gen Z has pivoted to a multi-screen, digital, on-the-go media consumption ecosystem. This generation seamlessly negotiates a massively fragmented, always-on, mobile-first landscape seeking customised information and experiences.

“Media has three primary use cases—escapism, information, and self-aggrandisement,” says Ashish Pherwani, Leader, Media & Entertainment sector, EY. “This hasn’t changed for Gen Z in as far as the relevance of media is concerned. What has changed is the how, the when, and the where.”

Gen Z, for instance, still wants to stay informed and is an active consumer of news and opinions, but it doesn’t go to legacy media

platforms such as physical newspapers or TV channels. An industry research shows that Gen Z sources its news from targeted sources on social platforms and prefers shorter formats.

According to UK-based consultancy Brand Finance, Gen Z’s attention span has shrunk from 20-30 minutes a few years ago to 8-10 minutes now. This makes formats such as “shorts” and “reels” more popular among them.

General entertainment, however, remains a mixed bag for this generation. The BT-PRICE Gen Z Consumption Behaviour Survey, for instance, finds that Gen Z follows a hybrid entertainment model by blending digital-first formats with selective out-of-home experiences.

Brand Finance, which conducts global research each year with over 2,00,000 respondents for its Brand Valuation report, has similar findings. “Shorts and reels are favoured,

but they do switch to big screens,” says Ajimon Francis, Managing Director, Brand Finance, India.

Claiming that nearly one in two users on JioHotStar platforms belongs is a Gen Z, a spokesperson says the generation responds to engaging content on platforms other than social media, too. “Discovery (of content) may begin with a moment, a highlight, or a live cultural event, but sustained viewing follows when relevance and authenticity align.”

On the big screen at home, Gen Z prefers sports events with cricket still reigning supreme among the male audiences. Reality shows such as Big Boss are popular but so are romance, comedy and action genres for OTT platforms and cinemas.

WANTED ‘PLUS’

Celebrities such as film or sports stars are losing favour among the Gen Z when it comes to seeking